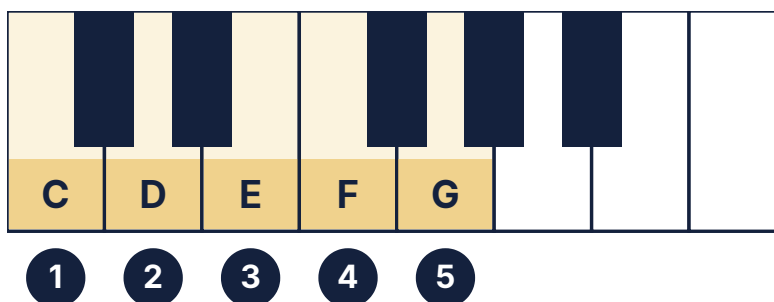


Your first piece, by ear

Every other book starts you reading. This one starts you playing. You will learn the opening of Beethoven's *Ode to Joy* today, with five fingers that never move — and there is nothing here to decode, because you already know how it goes.

WHERE YOUR HAND GOES



Right hand. Find any group of **two** black keys near the middle of the instrument; the white key immediately to its left is C. Thumb there, and the next four fingers fall on D, E, F and G without stretching. The hand does not move again in this piece.

THE TUNE — FOUR SHORT PHRASES · LETTER = KEY · SMALL NUMBER = FINGER · WIDE BOX WITH AN ORANGE BAR = HELD TWICE AS LONG

1	E 3	E 3	F 4	G 5
2	G 5	F 4	E 3	D 2
3	C 1	C 1	D 2	E 3
4	E 3	D 2	D 2	

1. **Sing it first.** Hum the tune before you touch the piano. If you cannot hum it, your hands will be guessing.
2. **Play phrase 1 alone**, slowly, saying the letter out loud — the letter, never the finger number. That one habit decides whether reading music stays slow for years.
3. **Add one phrase at a time.** Do not go on until the one before it comes out the same way twice in a row.
4. **Listen to the end of every note.** Let the arm drop the key rather than pressing it.

IF IT SOUNDS WRONG

Nine times out of ten the hand has crept away from its five keys. Find the group of two black keys again, reset the thumb on C, and start the phrase over. The position slips — not your ear.

One page from a method for adults learning on their own. The forty-one video lessons are free on YouTube, and you can send me a recording of your playing for written feedback — free while the pilot runs.